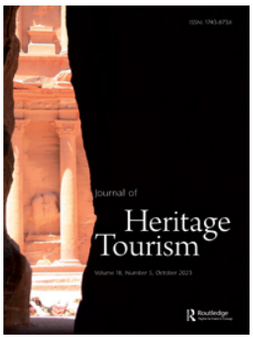

Journal of Heritage Tourism

ISSN: 1743-873X (Print) 1747-6631 (Online) Journal homepage: www.tandfonline.com/journals/rjht20

The solo pilgrim phenomenon on the Journey to Santiago de Compostela in Spain

Jiri Malis, David Masilka & Kristyna Janeckova

To cite this article: Jiri Malis, David Masilka & Kristyna Janeckova (2023) The solo pilgrim phenomenon on the Journey to Santiago de Compostela in Spain, Journal of Heritage Tourism, 18:5, 575-593, DOI: 10.1080/1743873X.2023.2201451

To link to this article: https://doi.org/10.1080/1743873X.2023.2201451

© 2023 The Author(s). Published by Informa UK Limited, trading as Taylor & Francis Group

Published online: 19 Apr 2023.

Submit your article to this journal

Article views: 3348

View related articles

View Crossmark data

Citing articles: 6 View citing articles

Full Terms & Conditions of access and use can be found at
https://www.tandfonline.com/action/journalInformation?journalCode=rjht20

JOURNAL OF HERITAGE TOURISM
2023, VOL. 18, NO. 5, 575–593
https://doi.org/10.1080/1743873X.2023.2201451

OPEN ACCESS Check for updates

The solo pilgrim phenomenon on the Journey to Santiago de Compostela in Spain

Jiri Malis [a], David Masilka[b] and Kristyna Janeckova [b]

[a]Department of Social Sciences in Kinanthropology, Faculty of Physical Culture, Palacky University Olomouc, Olomouc, Czech Republic; [b]Department of Recreation and Leisure Studies, Faculty of Physical Culture, Palacky University Olomouc, Olomouc, Czech Republic

ABSTRACT
This paper focuses on the advantages of pilgrimage for modern-day people, trying to find and describe phenomena that are integral to the pilgrim experience. The aim is to investigate this experience holistically, without any a priori focus on a specific phenomenon. The qualitatively-oriented research was based on semi-structured interviews conducted with seven Czech pilgrims, after their experience from a pilgrimage to Santiago de Compostela in Spain. The textual analyses were performed using the grounded theory method. The main finding is that the most significant benefit of pilgrimage is Intense Self-knowledge as a product of six phenomena: Disengagement from Everydayness, Solitude, Company on the Pilgrimage, Spirituality, Pain and Walking in the Camino Environment. Understanding this phenomenon helps us, in return, to understand the need of post-modern individuals for seeking this unique mode of travel, in which they are jolted out of their routine over an extended period of time and are exposed to an environment associated with a Christian tradition which is based on the archetypal need to wander to find sacredness.

ARTICLE HISTORY
Received 7 December 2022
Accepted 3 April 2023

KEYWORDS
Pilgrimage; walking; spirituality; Santiago de Compostela; intense self-knowledge

Introduction

In this article we will focus on the pilgrimage route to Santiago de Compostela, whose roots date back to the 9th century (Bottineau, 1997). The modern history of the pilgrimage starts with the issue in 1884 of the *Deus Omnipotens* bull by Pope Leo XIII, in which he proclaimed the rediscovered relics of St James as sacred (Davidson, 2014). However, the return of pilgrims was a lengthy process. According to Lopez (2013) and Santos (2022), the importance of the route was sealed in 1993, when the Camino became part of the UNESCO World Heritage List and the Way of St James became the main tourist symbol of Galicia and the city of Santiago de Compostela turned into an international tourist attraction (Guilarte & González, 2018).

The development of this pilgrimage route is mainly due to the close cooperation between the church and the state (Santos, 2022). Both entities were well aware of the site's potential, and started an information campaign, created the mascot, Pelegrin, and began exporting the pilgrimage brand of Xacobeo (Tilson, 2005). The successful marketing cooperation became evident during the celebrations of Holy Years, which were supported by the celebrations of the 800th anniversary of the

CONTACT Jiri Malis jiri.malis@upol.cz

© 2023 The Author(s). Published by Informa UK Limited, trading as Taylor & Francis Group
This is an Open Access article distributed under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivatives License (http://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-nd/4.0/), which permits non-commercial re-use, distribution, and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited, and is not altered, transformed, or built upon in any way. The terms on which this article has been published allow the posting of the Accepted Manuscript in a repository by the author(s) or with their consent.

consecration of the cathedral in 2011, the twelfth centenary of the discovery of St James' body in 2013, and the opening of the Holy Door in 2016 (Santos, 2016). Nowadays, hundreds of thousands of pilgrims come to Santiago each year (Statista, 2022).

Popularisation could not have been so successful without the inner human need for this unusual experience (Nilsson, 2018). The pilgrims and their needs and experience evolve together with cultural changes, although certain echoes of the past remain. It is still a pilgrimage to Santiago de Compostela, but with the changing environs of the pilgrim trail – which has been transformed from a walking path to a popular route with carefully constructed infrastructure, good marking, and a network of accommodation, from simple albergues to comfortable hotels – the human attitude to the reasons for taking the pilgrimage and what can be drawn from this extraordinary experience also change (González & Medina, 2003; Szerb et al., 2016).

In the past, the pilgrimage was closely connected to the Christian tradition; it was a journey to the Christian God (Ohler, 2003). On the other hand, the modern era is often said to be increasingly secularised (Nilsson & Tesfahuney, 2016); this secularisation, however, should not be viewed as a departure from faith in a general sense, but rather as a departure from a specific Christian church in the Western world and its replacement by a new church movement (Wilson, 2021). This departure from a specific church results from the individualisation of the liberal society, and thus people are seeking, more than ever, their own personal way, free of 'impersonal' tradition, towards something that transcends them (Deneen, 2018), because the need for transcendence remains strong (Gökarıksel, 2009); according to Cohen and Cohen (2014), the main motivation of a modern pilgrim is a pilgrimage on foot, something between the spiritual-religious level and the urge to visit historic sites, what Barreiro (1997) describe as 'sacred travel'. People still believe; it is just the faith that has changed its form, becoming more individualised, diverse, and hidden (Sharpley & Jepson, 2011). Davie (1994) terms it 'believing without belonging'. This also blurs the line between those who regard themselves as traditional believers (members of a certain church) and those who regard themselves as 'atheists' (Oviedo et al., 2014). But even the current atheist segments of society are able to experience the pilgrimage fully, not as a journey to the Christian God, but rather as a journey to something personal that transcends them (Farias et al., 2018). And this is where we are getting to the essence of our paper – the intention to disclose the personal benefits gained from the pilgrim experience and ask personal questions, such as these: What has the pilgrimage brought to you? What happened during the journey? What is so unique about the pilgrimage?

This paper focuses only on the experience of pilgrims who have made the pilgrimage solo. Pilgrimage is naturaly a personal contemplative journey to God and to the depths of the pilgrim's soul. Making a pilgrimage in a group distracts an individual from subjective experience, and therefore people – monks, saints, and Jesus himself – needed to withdraw in order to better perceive their inner voices. The psychological benefits of solitude are also mentioned by Long and Averill (2003). Solitude is important for us as it facilitates self-knowledge and deeper experience (Storr, 1989). One is not distracted so much by others and subjective authentic phenomena are thus enhanced (Jackson, 2016). We do not only focus on the pilgrim's spiritual experience or any other specific phenomenon; our intention was to embrace the pilgrim experience comprehensively. Our research is based on the phenomenological approach, trying to 'return to the substance' (Heidegger, 1977). A wealth of statistical data collected by the Oficina de Acogida al Peregrino in Santiago indicates why the pilgrims embark on the Camino, but does not answer the questions about the substance of the pilgrim's experience, as this data captures a superficial reality.

Methodology

Sample

Based on an intentional selection, the study involved seven pilgrims out of 11 respondents who were approached. Contact was made via social platforms devoted to the pilgrimage. The main criterion

for selection was that each person had to complete the pilgrimage alone. This means that he/she does not spend most of the journey with a specific person, but only meets other people by chance during the journey and spends some time with them, yet does not establish a closer relationship with anyone and does not spend the majority of the pilgrimage with them. Furthermore, the respondents have in common that they did not make use of the possibility of having their luggage transported and they did not sleep in hotels, but only in the albuerges or in the wild. Our sample included pilgrims who took the whole traditional French Way (Camino Francés) from Saint-Jean-Pied-de-Port in France, with a total distance of 769 km to Santiago de Compostela, or the Northern Way (Camino del Norte) from Irún, Spain, with a total distance of 830 km. The sample also includes pilgrims who continued to Muxía or Cape Finisterre. Another selection criterion was that they were of the same nationality as the researchers in order to not only minimise misinterpretation of the interviews caused by potential language barriers, but also, for the respondents themselves, it is more comfortable and easier to describe personal experiences if we are all speaking in our native language. Age, gender, and education were not among the limiting criteria for the participants. Below is a summary of the main characteristics of the respondents (Table 1).

Materials and methods

The study of the pilgrim experience on the way to Santiago de Compostela was performed using the grounded theory method. Data were collected from 2016 to 2019. Figure 1 shows the theoretical conceptual model attained through the data processing. All parts of the substantive theory of the pilgrimage experience presented are based on the data and are back-anchored in the data through the evidential citations presented.

When working with the data, we strove to find the meanings in the narratives about individual experience during the pilgrimage. We then encoded the individual parts of the text so that the codes could reflect the facts hidden in the data better and more efficiently. The coding process was aimed at analysing and describing the phenomena that formed the pilgrim experience, in the following steps:

a) identification of the phenomena that formed the pilgrim experience;
b) analysis and description of the relationships between the phenomena that were identified;
c) formulation of a substantive theory capturing the pilgrim experience, supported by data.

Coding Phase.

We used three-stage coding – open coding, axial coding, and selective coding. In the first stage of the coding, we identified the individual semantic units in the data from the interviews and diaries.

Table 1. Basic description of the pilgrims.

Pilgrim	Jan[a]	Petr	Karel	Rachel	Adam[a]	Hugo[a]	Lenka
profession	student	teacher	student	Worker	engineer	student	student
confession	atheist	atheist	Catholic	Catholic	Catholic	atheist	Catholic
Age	32	52	25	54	31	28	24
Days spent	37	25	21	180	29	39	28
Route	Northern Way	French Way	Northern Way	French Way	Northern Way	Northern Way	French Way
Start	Irún	S. J. *P. P.*[a]	Irún	Jihlava	Bilbao	Irún	S. J. *P. P.*[a]
Destination	Muxía	Santi. de C.	Muxía	Santander[b]	Muxía	Muxía	Santi. de C.
km	980	770	670	3000	800	980	770
Interview 1	27 min.	23	32	28	59	39	29
Interview 2	30 min.	25	18	46	17	17	26
Diary	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	No

[a]S. J. *P. P.* – Saint-Jean-Pied-de-Port.
[b]Santander – Rachel reached Santiago de Compostela and then decided to return to the Czech Republic along the North Way, but ended her journey in Santander, after approximately six months of pilgrimage.

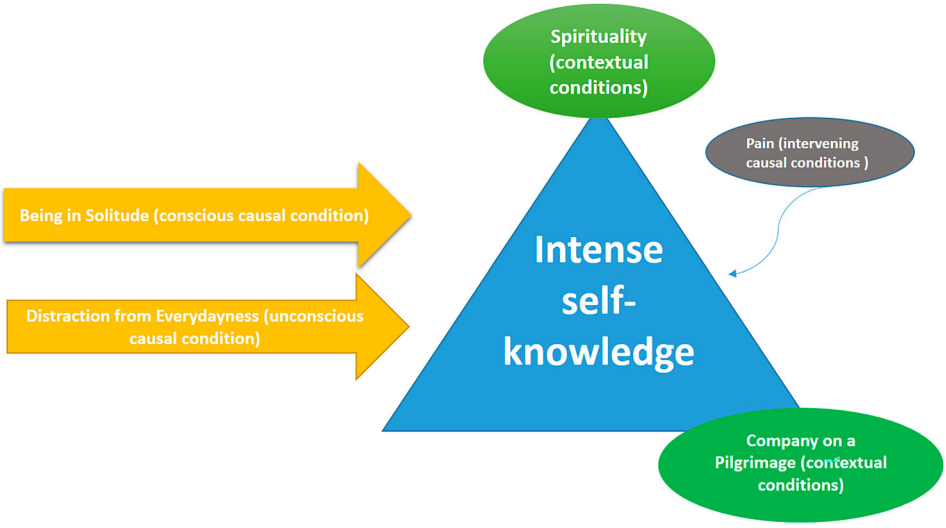

Figure 1. Central category and its relation to surrounding phenomena.

Every such unit has its own content and represents one meaning. This was followed by the constant comparison method, during which we searched for the individual semantic units, compared them, and searched for similarities and differences among them. We clustered similar units into umbrella codes, and seamlessly passed to the second, axial stage of coding, which concluded with the creation of categories that were created on the basis of the gradual discovery of deeper contextual relationships between the individual codes, with subsequent agglomeration into groups of a higher level of content (Corbin & Strauss, 2012). The main categories were: Spirituality; Pain; Company on the Pilgrimage; Being in Solitude; Intense Self-knowledge; Walking in the Camino Environment, and Disengagement from Everydayness. During the last stage – selective coding – we examined the mutual relationships between the categories (Corbin & Strauss, 2012) and decided on the central organisational concept, [i.e.] the main or central category. The central category chosen was Intense Self-knowledge, and this phenomenon will be described in relation to the surrounding phenomena; see Figure 1 below.

Results

Intense self-knowledge – central category

Inscribed in the forecourt of the mythical Temple of Apollo (oracle) at Delphi was the maxim 'gnōthi seauton – know thyself'. This symbolic inscription in the ancient oracle tells us that humans can only understand their fate and position in the world if they know themselves. The pilgrimage to Santiago de Compostela offers a pilgrim an opportunity to gain intense self-knowledge. It becomes what many Christian philosophers put on the highest level of importance, self-knowledge, because it is only through self-knowledge that man gains the knowledge of God (Grün, 2005). Some of the pilgrims who were interviewed had this goal in mind ('to know myself better' [J, I1]); for many of them this was a phenomenon they had not mentioned before, but it was an enriching experience for all of them.

The phenomenon of Intense Self-knowledge is simply understood as the declaration of the pilgrims who claim to have learnt more about themselves during the pilgrimage. The pilgrimage becomes a place where one rediscovers one's authentic self; it is about 'getting to know yourself' (K, I1), about immersing yourself 'in the depths of your soul' (A, I1) and having the opportunity to 'answer your internal questions … ' (J, I1). 'I managed to find the truth in myself' (K, I1). During

the pilgrimage, one becomes more aware about one's relationship to one's surroundings, about how egocentric one sometimes is, and that one should learn to see the world from the perspective of other people by simply looking at one's own life 'from a fresh perspective': 'I often wished to approach some things from the perspective of others, not from my own perspective, in order not to be so selfish and think about them more. This is one of the things that I maybe found beneficial' (K, I1). Pilgrims widely ask God (or something beyond themselves) for help, as is also the case here, which brings us to the spiritual level of the pilgrimage, understood as an inseparable part of the human personality. Self-knowledge was also one of the motives for 'why I went there, and I felt I was becoming myself during the pilgrimage' (A, I1). The strong experience of the Intense Self-knowledge phenomenon was positively stimulated by the phenomena described below, which are an inseparable part of the pilgrim experience along the journey to Santiago de Compostela.

The *Intense* Self-knowledge phenomenon is the central product of the pilgrim experience and as such, it is co-created by six subcategories: Solitude; Spirituality; Disengagement from Everydayness, Company on the Pilgrimage and Pain (Figure 2).

Solitude

The pilgrims were seeking solitude because they felt that the true pilgrim experience is walking in solitude: 'When you're walking with someone, it's hiking rather than a pilgrimage' (J, I1). Solitude 'clears your head of useless thoughts' (P, I1) and the pilgrims go into the depths of their individual, personal problems: 'you answer questions you didn't even know you have' (K, I1); 'solitude is good for being most honest to myself' (L, I1). Over time, pilgrims actively seek solitude, as it brings them immense freedom: 'I want to be with myself, for myself, and in myself' (P, D). Pilgrims do not need to 'show regard to anybody', they walk 'at their own pace' (J, I1). And thanks to solitude, the pilgrim behaves spontaneously, personal needs emerge naturally because one 'doesn't rely on anybody' (P, I1), and everything comes from within the person: 'When I was completely alone, I was totally satisfied with it' (A, I2). The pilgrim wants to walk 'alone to get closer to myself' (H, I1). Solitude is important for the pilgrims from the spiritual point of view; they are open to more transcendental

Figure 2. Intense self-knowledge and its subcategories.

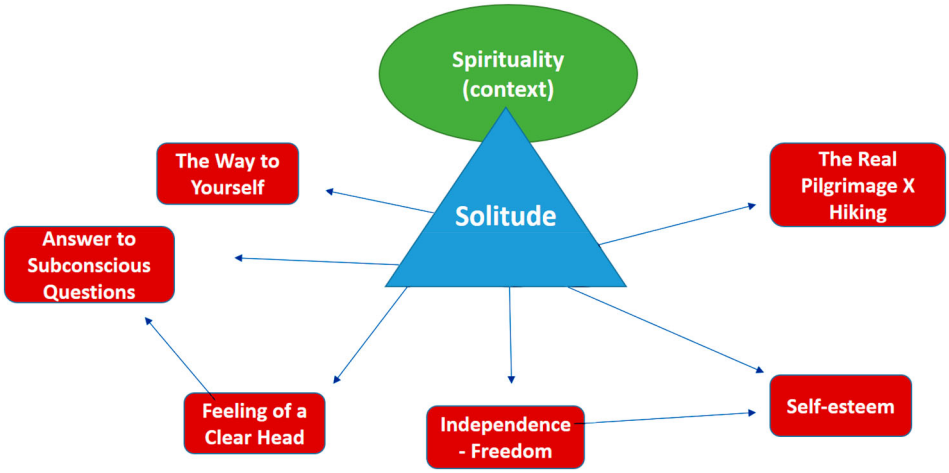

Figure 3. Solitude and its subcategories.

thoughts, towards which pilgrims naturally incline during the journey. There will be more on this topic in the following part (Figure 3).

Spirituality

The spiritual experience of the pilgrims is very strongly connected to the need to 'commit to the journey' (A, I1). The pilgrims feel that 'these are the ways of the soul. … you feel that, you're right and you're going in the right direction' (H, I1). 'God sends the right person your way' (K, I1) and 'I got lost many times. … I always met someone who gave me a piece of advice … I realised that God is the shepherd and will not leave any of his sheep' (K, D). This help was also interpreted by one pilgrim as a connection to something transcendental: 'Even though I am alone, I feel I am not alone, I feel everything is controlled' (K, D) and another said 'I was on a journey and I felt I was in union with Christ' (L, I1).

During the pilgrimage, people are more open to thoughts for which they have no time in their working life. We believe spiritual experience is partially conditional on the duration and solitude of the pilgrimage, as the pilgrim is able to stop and think about the most ordinary events around them and put them in a broader context, becoming part of a greater whole:

> I was watching ants for a long time, thinking about the collective consciousness, about the interconnected world, about the energy flowing through living things, like water in the trees. … I feel my thoughts are clearer, I think somehow easier. … Solitude awakens spirituality in me and my thoughts are often surreal … there is no judge except the originator of the idea; there's no-one to keep the surreal thoughts outside. (J, D)

The pilgrim frequently enters a state of mind in which they do not view things and events primitively, but search for a deeper meaning in them, a symbolism of life where a hill is not just a hill, but it symbolises Golgotha:

> Climbing a hill … . giving a lot of thought to the overcoming of obstacles … hill itself represented obstacles we encounter during our lives. I was thinking about Jesus' suffering when he was crucified upon a hill and returned to God after his torment. … experience when I was living through obstacles and their significance, not just on this journey, but as a fundamental part of our lives … It was an intimate experience of suffering and its significance. (J, I1)

According to the study of Schnell and Pali (2013), pilgrimage has a positive impact on realising the meaning of one's life and overcoming personal crises through transcendence (spirituality or religiosity). An important aspect of spiritual stories is, however, dealing with the past. The pilgrim realises the sins of the past, processes them, and copes with them through pilgrimage. Similar results

were obtained by Tignor and Colvin (2019), who argue that reconciliation with the past and with feelings of guilt has adaptive effects on an individual and can ultimately lead to their pro-social behaviour. Therefore, a pilgrimage has a therapeutic effect, intensified positively by the pilgrim community; see Figure 4 below.

Company on the pilgrimage – emphasis on linking to the central phenomenon

Although the pilgrims went on a pilgrimage alone, contact with other people is an everyday thing on such a busy pilgrimage. At the start, the pilgrims felt the 'need to be alone': 'At first, I felt it as purely negative (meeting other pilgrims), but I think it's great to a certain extent because meeting these people is an essential part of the pilgrimage' (J, I1). A very strong role is played by the feeling of social equality of the pilgrims: 'Everyone goes there knowing that it doesn't matter who they are, that they might be an engineer walking side by side with a homeless person and having a great chat, that the social hierarchy between classes has no place there' (H, I1). The pilgrim experience also includes strong in-group favouritism towards other pilgrims: 'As soon as you see a person with a backpack and a cane in their hand, you simply feel friendship, no matter where they come from' (K, I1). This common purpose, goal, and sense of the day creates new communities with strong bonds of solidarity, and the pilgrims are considerably more honest with each other:

> … that we weren't afraid to tell each other things I would never tell anyone … Coming to terms with myself, I get to know other people, too, and I can communicate with them well, differently to the group of people you know from home. (K, I1)

'These relationships were interesting by being totally natural. You can speak about anything and it just doesn't feel forced' (A, I1). The gradual formation of a community carries with it a feeling of exceptionality and the need to distance oneself from 'other hikers' who do not go through the whole pilgrimage: 'Those who were there for a longer stretch of time, a month for instance, were more open and I could naturally talk to them about personal matters, it wasn't so superficial' (J, I1; Figure 5).

Disengagement from everydayness

The time spent on a pilgrimage also plays a major role in the experience of Intense self-knowledge. Each pilgrim from our research sample went on a pilgrimage for at least 21 days. With each passing day spent on the pilgrimage, the pilgrims began perceiving the time differently, as the days are not

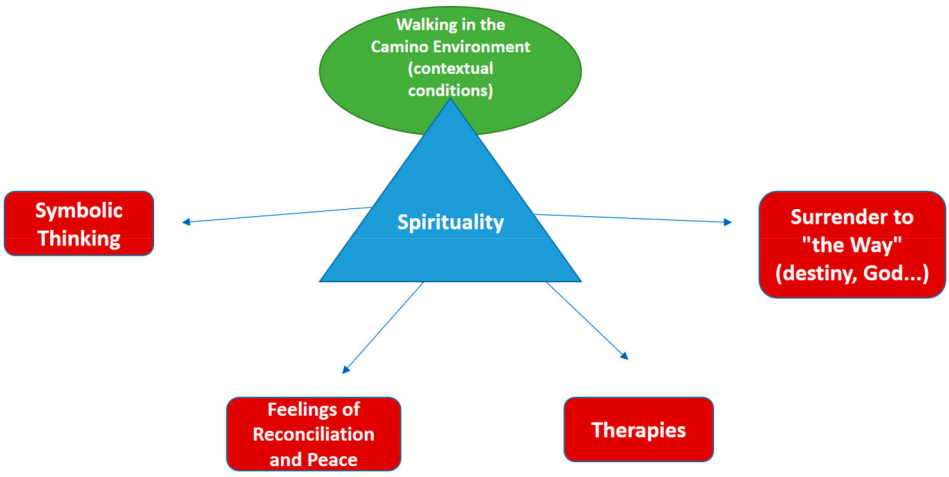

Figure 4. Spirituality and its subcategories.

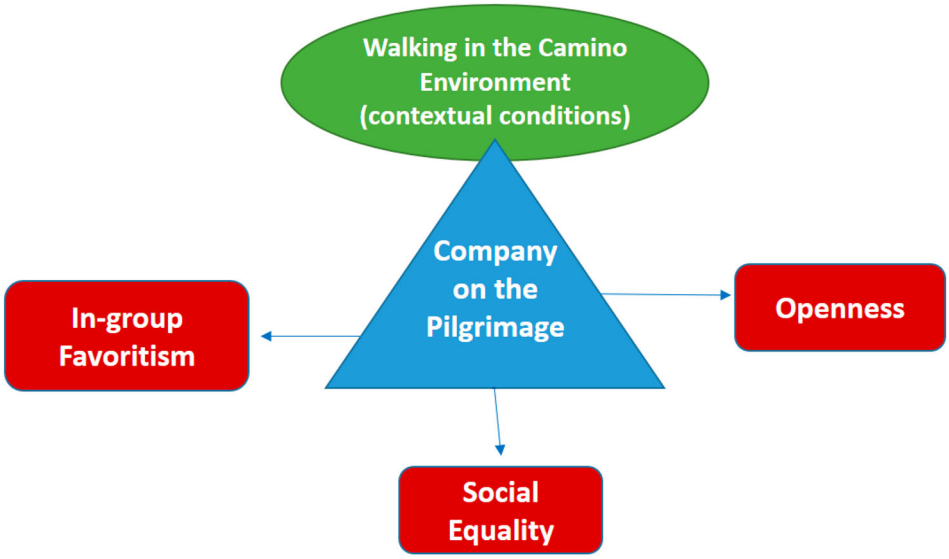

Figure 5. Company on the pilgrimage and its subcategories.

measured by the ticking clock, but only by the day-night cycle; the only daily activity is to wake up in the morning, arrive wherever one may roam, and get refreshed regularly. The pilgrims have the whole day for themselves and their thoughts. It is necessary to get used to this primitive lifestyle, and therefore the pilgrimage should extend for several weeks: 'I remained in the old patterns for the first few days,' (R, I1), because time is needed to wash away the lifestyle brought to the pilgrimage, so that one can enter the mode of 'here and now' (H, I1). The pilgrim's thoughts can focus better on their own experience, something that is virtually impossible in the hustle and bustle of the working day. The pilgrims experience strong feelings of freedom and an overall calming, which is also supported by the routine of the pilgrimage days. The perception of time was beautifully described by one of the pilgrims, who mentioned two types of time - the normal working time we encounter in our everyday lives is Chronos, but pilgrimage is dominated by Kairos, which disengages us from everydayness:

> Kairos, during which my behaviour and actions follow my current mood and what I want to do at the moment – and that makes a big difference – cannot be compared to my normal life in civilised surroundings; you can't actually experience that in civilisation if you are leading your working life or are of active age and have to go to work and make money in order to survive. (R, I1)

Similarly to solitude, free time is also associated with the feeling of freedom because the pilgrims are not forced to perform any duties beyond the framework of meeting basic needs such as food and sleep ('You have a lot of time for everything.' [J, I2]). Outside the pilgrimage, one is part of the system that tells one what to do: 'I'm free on a pilgrimage … Here (at home) it's governed by work' (R, I1). It takes more than a few days to break free from the everyday routine and gain a new insight or a possibility of seeing things from another perspective: 'It wouldn't come into effect in a week; I really have to be there for almost a month' (P, I1). The pilgrims talk about spending a longer time on a pilgrimage because:

> The farther I was and the more days I spent on the journey, the more it seemed to me that I'd found something … The kilometres are the least concern; the shift is in your mind … What I was dealing with at the start and at the end was totally different. (R, I1)

During the journey, the pilgrims get into 'a routine that your head knows what you're going to do, you're going to walk; you stop somewhere, eat, get accommodated, set up your sleeping bag, wash, eat, sleep … You don't need to think about it.' With a certain level of automatisation, one finally reaches the 'flow state' (H, I1) (Csikszentmihalyi, 1990) and experiences spontaneous 'unconditional

feelings of joy, calm … these came about after three or four weeks on the journey' (J, I1). An important experience is that temporal freedom where there is nowhere to rush to, maybe with the exception of the kilometres travelled, brings feelings of calm and deeper enjoyment of the present moment: 'It was more vibrant. Whenever I wanted, I could decide not to go on or to have another kind of day. So yes, I was definitely living in the present moment' (R, I1). The pilgrim is not so distracted by the need to keep a memory of a beautiful sight through a camera, for instance: 'I don't even take pictures. It's all for the moment and for the eyes, anyway, it all takes place at that moment … Days don't seem to matter there – you simply walk every day!' (H, D) With each passing day, the pilgrim 'becomes more balanced, calmed by the feeling of an emptier head and happiness' (Figure 6).

Pain

The hardship associated with the journey is an essential part of the pilgrim experience, subsumed here under the simple concept of Pain. From the first days, 'my legs hurt' (P, D). 'The sign behind the town says there's only 763 km left → I feel unwell because my little toe is swollen, my hips are abraded like an old closet, and the trapezoid has no trigger points – it simply hurts like hell' (H, D). And as time passes by, 'fatigue adds up' (P, D), 'I wasn't able to get out of bed because of fatigue and my legs, hurt so much' (A, D). It is common that pilgrims 'feel pain in tendons' (P, D), 'blisters … pain spreads to the whole body' (A, D), 'it's pure suffering' (L, D). During the journey, the pilgrims sometimes have feelings of doubt about finishing the pilgrimage because of these efforts: 'I was sure I would have to give up, because last night, I could barely get out of bed to go to the bathroom' (A, D). Overcoming these doubts about finishing adds value to the whole experience. It is important to note that in general, the pilgrims considered the pain as mainly a positive part of the journey. Pain maintained the pilgrim in the here-and-now state: 'Good pain makes you deal with the current problem, so you are not distracted by other things' (A, I1). The pilgrims contemplate the significance of pain, which becomes an important part of the experience, a kind of necessity for deeper experience:

> I don't know if pain can act as a cure. Without physical exertion, there would be no feeling of purity of the heart. I am convinced it's because of the exertion, pain, persistence, [etc.] I would call it a spiritual topic, it was because of that physical as well as mental overcoming, and because it was so long. (P, I1)

By overcoming fatigue, pain, and the general hardships associated with the daily walking, pilgrims gained confidence in themselves and their physical fitness: 'You realise that the body can handle much more than you think. This was a surprise. I think one of the lessons is that we underrate our bodies' (A, I1).

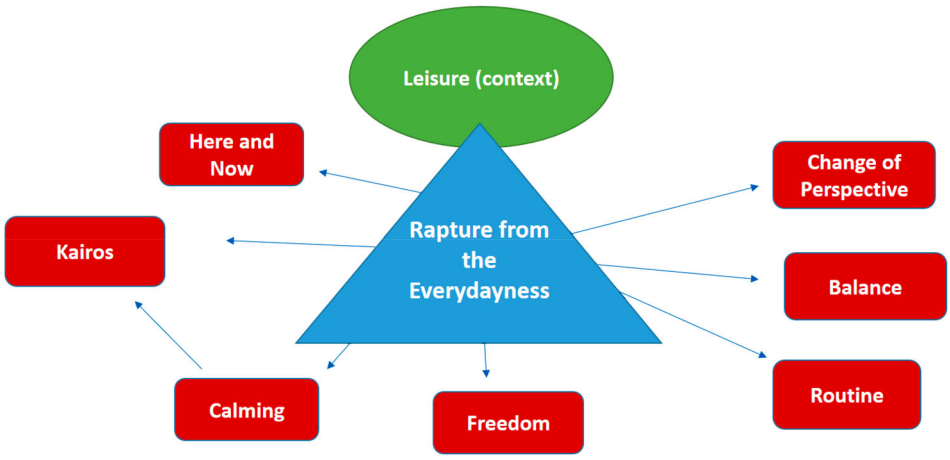

Figure 6. Rapture from the everydayness and its subcategories.

It was evident especially in the Christian pilgrims that the exertion and pain 'is worth it' (L, I1) and that it is a form of sacrifice:

> The physical demands – if it were easy, everyone would go, right? But if you decide to do something like this, it sure will cost you. You have high hopes and seek something in the pilgrimage, but you need to make a sacrifice. I'm going on foot because nothing makes this journey easier. You have to offer your best. (K, I1)

'When I hit the bottom, when I make all this effort, I add value to it' (L, I1). Thanks to this effort, the Christian pilgrims can 'ask more of God' (L, I1; Figures 7 and 8).

Discussion

The pilgrimage to Santiago de Compostela is a sufficiently long distraction from everyday hustle and bustle, and the pilgrim comes to a new environment. On the basis of the data that was processed, we established that the central category is the pilgrim's Intense self-knowledge as a product of the six phenomena described: Disengagement from Everydayness; Solitude; Company on the Pilgrimage; Spirituality; Pain; and Walking in the Camino Environment. Sørensen and Høgh-Olesen (2022) arrived at similar conclusions in their cross-sectional study, also specifying six main themes emerging from the pilgrimage, while two different themes were the simplicity of life and the transformative potential of the pilgrimage.

This paper is an attempt at understanding the pilgrim's world, which, as the results revealed, is a unique withdrawal from the life of each of us. Husserl calls this universe 'Lebenswelt' (*life-world*). The Lebenswelt evolves constantly during our lives, and there is often no time left in our everydayness for self-reflection, for evaluation of our own way of life. According to Patočka (1969), our existence opens up to us through our activity. In our case, this activity is walking with a specific direction, goal, and pilgrimage. The environment of a pilgrimage, with everything that goes with it, contributes positively to thinking more deeply about ourselves, resulting in a certain level of self-reflection that leads to a new view of ourselves, but also of our overall attitude towards the world around us (Pedersen, 1999).

Spirituality

The pilgrimage itself means 'walking to the house of God' (Bible, Psalm 55:14) and this process, naturally, awakens spirituality in a person (Ahlbäck, 1993). Santiago de Copostela may be

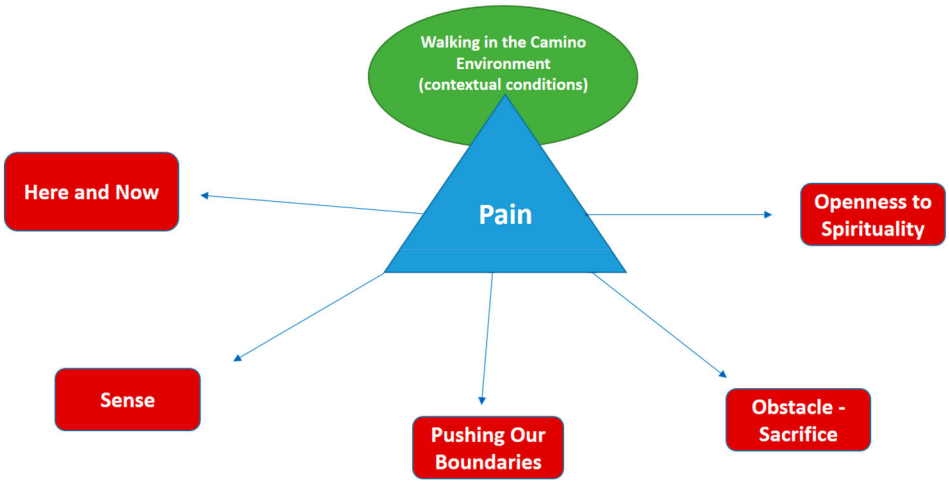

Figure 7. Pain and its subcategories.

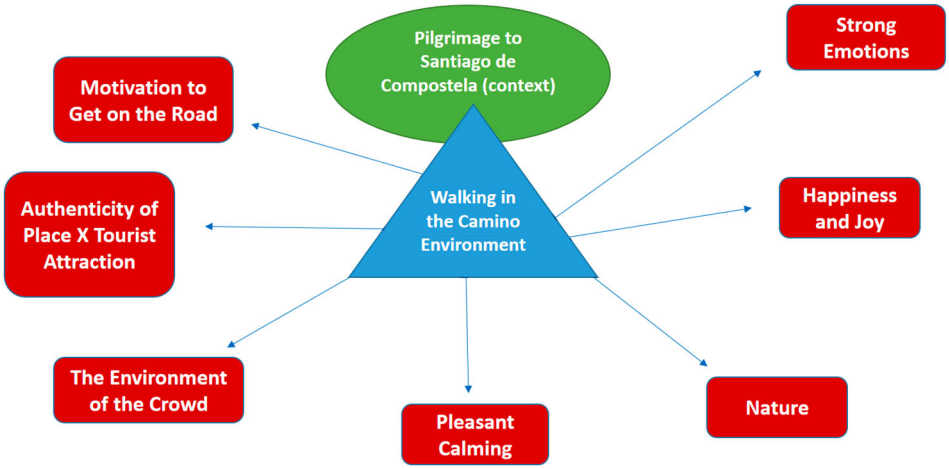

Figure 8. Walking in the Camino environment and its subcategories.

historically tied to the Christian religion, but the profound spiritual experiences are not only for believers, but equally for atheists. For both of these groups, 'spiritual searching' was the main motivation for making the walking pilgrimage (Farias et al., 2018). Korstanje (2018) points out that the increasing interest in pilgrimage to Santiago de Compostela is due to the need of Europeans for spiritual experience, and the Camino associates both spiritual and religious experience (Sánchez-Carretero, 2015). Reader (2007) speaks of a spiritual revolution not a revival of religious sentiments. Thus, the desire for spirituality becomes the main motivation for pilgrims to make the pilgrimage (Amaro et al., 2018).

Sacred places like Santiago contain spiritual magnetism created by the participants, and not by the place itself (Preston & Morinis, 1992). Pilgrimage is an ideal environment for the deepening of personal spirituality, which is also associated with self-exploration and self-realisation (Brown, 2013; Kim & Jamal, 2007). Müller (2003) mentions that through journeying, it is possible to experience stronger transcendental feelings, and the same is felt by the pilgrims who feel the need to submit to 'God', especially in moments of discomfort. What is paradoxical about this coping strategy is the fact that submitting to 'It' surprisingly increases the feeling of the person's control of the situation (Cole & Pargament, 1999). Submitting to 'It' is described by Cole and Pargament (1999) as a way of finding a meaning in mentally and physically demanding situations, 'It' would not allow that what I am going through has no sense at all, and this submitting to 'It' brings calm associated with meaningfulness. Although I do not understand it, 'Something' is above me, and this 'Something' perceives the meaning. It is important to realise the human need for control of the situation when he/she rationally loses control. In these situations, the pilgrim's recourse is submitting to 'flow with the current of life' (Rothbaum et al., 1982, p. 8). 'It' becomes the pilgrim's partner, and thanks to that, the pilgrim copes better with the hardships of the journey, as they are in the best hands possible and can light-heartedly commit to the 'journey' (Cole & Pargament, 1999). This need for commitment to something that transcends us is an inseparable part of spiritual life, described by Christians as unity with God, and as one of our pilgrims put it, 'I am allied with Christ.' This experience also includes therapeutic aspects because they bring the pilgrim greater well-being, deepen their hope and self-esteem, and increase meaningfulness (Schnell & Pali, 2013), as some pilgrims describe the Camino as 'la ruta de la terapia', because the people here 'rework the past' and possibly 'move toward a renewed future' (Frey, 1998, p. 45). Turner and Manning (2016) also points out that companionship that reveals the pilgrim's unconscious mind also possesses a therapeutic function.

Company on the pilgrimage

A pilgrimage is about leaving the old behind and discovering the new. According to Gamper and Reuter (2012), 40% of pilgrims embark on a journey specifically to leave a familiar community. Turner and Turner (1996) describes the pilgrimage as a rite of passage, during which one shrugs off one's usual social role and replaces it with the role of a traveller. The experience of the new social role is an important part of the pilgrimage, as one can leave behind all-too-familiar social relations. Through this new role, an individual can also better evaluate their role in everyday life, from which they acquire distance while on the pilgrimage.

Although the pilgrims set off alone and initially tried to keep their distance from others, it was only a matter of time before the natural human need to associate with people close to them prevailed. Even though a pilgrim may be an atheist, he/she enters the imaginary ground of an ancient tradition and rituals that create a feeling of belonging to a certain group. This belonging is also manifested by the common appearance by which individuals represent their social affiliation, and this is also the case for pilgrims (Barreiro, 1997). Since the Middle Ages, Christian pilgrims have worn specific garments complemented with a pilgrim's staff and pilgrim's passport, and also with a symbolic shell in the case of pilgrims to Santiago de Compostela. The journey was frequently preceded by a ritual mass and a priest's blessing. All these petty rituals increased unity with other pilgrims (Seligman, 2008). Although pilgrims usually set off alone, meeting other travellers awakened extraordinary warmth caused by the common lot. According to Koopmans (2011), the shared experience from the journey was ultimately the most important aspect of creating a community. On a pilgrimage, this bond is created by the common lot, common destination, shared effort, and the spiritual significance of the whole experience; the pilgrimage is a specific kind of ritual creating a strong feeling of community (Sosis & Alcorta, 2003). A homogeneous and egalitarian society is established there, as the pilgrims find themselves outside the traditional cultural structures. An individual becomes, as Turner and Turner (1996) wrote, part of a '*communitas*', or society, which is immediate and spontaneous, and the pilgrim is a little outside the community, while being in close contact with his/her soul (Kapusta, 2011). Pilgrims are greatly altruistic toward their fellow-pilgrims; they cook shared meals, share common lodgings and often also values, and this society is permeated with very strong pro-social behaviour (Sosis & Alcorta, 2003). Embracing the new role of a pilgrim and entering the new community is an important aspect of the pilgrimage (Turner & Turner, 1996). This requires revision of the old role one plays outside the pilgrimage. We know how to act in a familiar environment and we know the likely response to our actions. The way an individual communicates and presents themselves obliges them to certain behaviour, as the group categorises them accordingly and it is then difficult to escape from that role because the established functioning of the group would be disturbed, leading to its social destabilisation (Belk & Costa, 1998). As Goffman (1959) puts it, life is a stage and everyone plays a role. This theorem nicely complements the original meaning of the word 'persona' – a mask – and it is this mask that we wear in specific communities. The mask is co-created by our innate need to establish the ideal self we present outwardly, as well as by the effects of the public toward us. We enter the world as individuals, but we gradually become personas (Goffman, 1959). On a pilgrimage, we are deprived of this company, and we create a new role, one in which we can express ourselves in full again and anew.

According to Bruner (2005), the experience of friendship and community that surrounds us on our travels is one of the most important experiences ever. On the one hand, people on a pilgrimage are strangers of various nationalities, but on the other, the pilgrimage and the common lot unite them, thanks to which a feeling of friendship forms very quickly and people are more open to personal issues. We are among equals, as there is no difference between a lawyer or truck driver on a pilgrimage – everyone is a pilgrim there (Wang, 1999). The pilgrim's true self is not lost in the public work roles of the modern Western society (Berger et al., 1973) and this distance from work roles has a positive impact on the pilgrim's mental health (Turner & Manning, 2016).

Strong attachment to a group brings about in-group favouritism (Miles et al., 2009), which has positive aspects, as described above, but also negative ones. It is a feeling of exclusivity towards

others. Pilgrims often feel somewhat superior to those who do not walk all the way, those who have their baggage transported, generally those who do not fulfil their idea of a pilgrim and his/her pilgrimage (Frey, 1998). The others are, pejoratively, referred to as 'mere hikers'. Pilgrims experience their feelings of exclusivity because they are not on a hike or tourist trip – they decided to devote a long time to walking for something that transcends them.

This makes us wonder who is the pilgrim?

Today, pilgrimage is losing its purely religious character and thus the distinction between pilgrim and tourist is beginning to blur (Allcock, 1988; Sharpley & Sundaram, 2005). MacCannell (1976) argues that tourist attractions are essentially sanctuaries for modern travellers and both the pilgrim and the tourist seek an authentic experience in their journey. This quest for authenticity is a strong motive for tourism, which thus becomes the equivalent of a religious pilgrimage, hence the term 'pilgrimage tourism' (Collins-Kreiner & Kliot, 2000; Nilsson & Tesfahuney, 2016). It would be a mistake, however, to loosely conflate the two terms. The boundaries between pilgrim and tourist are admittedly blurred, for as Turner and Turner (1978) write, in every pilgrim there is a piece of the tourist and in every tourist there is a piece of the pilgrim, on the other hand, although we could hardly think of an experience that would be found in only one category, there are phenomena that are more typical of one or the other category of traveller.

The need to distinguish between these two concepts is also evident among travellers themselves, who feel the need to define themselves in relation to 'ordinary' tourists, as tourist often has pejorative connotations for them (Frey, 1998).

In our opinion, Jirásek (2014) has appropriately focused on the very experience of people on the move. For the tourist, the important experience and motive for travel is the destination itself. This destination may be, as for the pilgrim, for example, a historical, religious place such as Santiago de Compostela. The tourist usually travels to this destination by means of transport and sees a large number of historical monuments in a few days, his attention is fluid and also evaluative. The tourist evaluates the quality of what he sees, his attention is turned outwards. The pilgrim, on the other hand, arrives at his destination laden with new experiences. This geographical ending of the pilgrimage is merely a delimitation of the whole phenomenon of the pilgrimage, which has been shaped in the course of the pilgrimage, not created at its end. For the pilgrim, unlike the tourist, the destination does not play a decisive role in the experience itself. While the pilgrim's destination gives meaning to the journey, its value is created during the journey itself. The journey creates the value of the destination, and the destination is the culmination of a long-term endeavour. Sheldrake (1994) argues that the tourist sucks the energy out of a place of pilgrimage; in contrast, the pilgrim recharges it.

The pilgrims themselves are very sensitive to defining the boundaries of the 'true' pilgrim, and these boundaries are subjective in nature. We observe a certain general tendency of the pilgrim to adjust this boundary to correspond to their personal way of travelling. Thus, if I walk, only those who walk are true pilgrims, but if I ride a bicycle, I am a pilgrim because I am on the pilgrimage route, etc. (Frey, 1998).

Solitude

According to tradition, the first prominent Christian herald of solitude was Anthony the Great (Lawrence, 2001) who decided, in the third century, to live in the Egyptian desert to get closer to God. This need to retire to solitude in order not to be distracted by the surroundings soon spread to the whole Christian world, and strong feelings of solitary contemplation with God became an integral part of the pilgrim experience from the very beginning of this pilgrimage tradition. The experience of solitude and immersion into oneself was rendered nicely by Nietzsche, who described it as a condition where one opens up to spirituality, frees the ego from external impulses, and revives the mind by returning to oneself (Nietzsche & Middleton, 1969).

For our times, it is especially important to realise how, since times long past, people have realised the significance of restraining external stimuli to harmonise their inner world, as a better way of

communicating not just with God, but also with themselves. The solitude perceived by the pilgrims is generally viewed as one of the most important phenomena of the pilgrimage. It is not perceived negatively, but positively, as a voluntary choice to be alone without feeling lonely, as the use of space just for oneself (Coplan & Bowker, 2014) and 'Through silence the Camino is converted into a sacrament of life in which the many hours of walking serve to help internalize all that one lives and feels' (Frey, 1998, p. 120).

Thanks to solitude, people can re-conceptualise their view of the self, not seeing themselves as members of a certain social stratum, which can be defined, for instance, by their working position (Storr, 1989). Metaphorically, people on a pilgrimage are faced with their self-portrait. Nowadays, numerous studies confirm this positive impact of solitude (Larson, 1990). The pilgrims often mention how clear their head and thoughts were, claiming they think more easily, a fact that is probably caused by the reduction of external stimuli through being in solitude. They can concentrate better and are more creative, they self-reflect on their past, and the thoughts come to light together with emotions (Figurski, 2012). Thanks to deeper self-understanding, one gets into harmony with oneself as well as with other people because, if we understand ourselves and our reactions and emotions, we are more likely to understand others (Herrmann et al., 2017). A strong experience that pilgrims associate with the positive effect of solitude is the feeling of freedom, as they have long days all for themselves and do not have to take anyone else into consideration. This realisation comes and deepens with the time spent on the journey (Hammitt, 1982). Walking solo brings pilgrims inner peace and space to open up to themselves and their spirituality (Frey, 1998, p. 134).

Solitude also has negative aspects, such as an inability to share the hardships and joys with a loved one, but only one of our pilgrims emphasised the negative effects of solitude; they were mentioned by other pilgrims from our set, but only to a negligible extent; in other words, solitude was an entirely positive experience for them.

Pain

Fatigue and pain play a specific role in pilgrims. People usually avoid pain, and if pain comes, they try to get rid of it. It is necessary to remember that our research group comprises both Christians and atheists. The Christians lean on the biblical interpretation of pain, traditionally associated with human sinfulness. Every painful step connects us to the authentic experience of true pilgrimage, pain brings us grace (Frey, 1998). We suffer because we are sinful, and can only be redeemed through pain: 'without the shedding of blood there is no forgiveness' (Hebrews 9,22). In the Christian tradition man is born sinful as a result of original sin, described metaphorically as the stealing of an apple from the Tree of Knowledge in the Garden of Eden. The result of this act is human suffering, through which man is to rediscover the paradise lost. Human faith is then frequently tried by God through torment, as in the story of Job, or in the case of Abraham's trial. In both cases, God shows us that there is purpose to suffering (Lewis, 2012). The story of suffering culminates in the very story of God who takes human form and is crucified as Jesus on the cross to redeem the sinful human race (Glucklich, 2003). The key role of pain in the Christian tradition is its association with sacrifice for something that transcends us. The perception of pain as a sacrifice to God was strongly represented in the data given by our group of pilgrims, which is consistent with Frey (1998), who claims that a pilgrim needs to experience pain, as thanks to it they deserve absolution.

In the case of the non-Christian pilgrims, pain was also perceived as an integral part of the whole experience, adding depth and sense to it. Pain forms human experience, as the mind is not separated from the physical body, it is inseparable from it, and strong physical manifestations affect our experience of reality (Good, 1994). Man is a being that seeks sense (Frankl, 2006), and thus tries to find it in pain as well, a fact that leads to them coping better with pain (Tisdell, 2013). Conversely, if one does not expect to experience suffering and is unable to accept pain, then one suffers even more during the journey and interprets it as less enjoyable, and it exposes one to deeper existential

questions as a result of one's lack of control over the situation, leading to re-evaluation of the way one sees oneself (Good, 1994). A long and physically demanding pilgrimage alone leads to changes of consciousness, as a result of which subconsciousness is unblocked and emotions, concealed up to that moment, resurface and enter the individual's consciousness. This is facilitated not only by pain, but also by solitude and the supportive pilgrim community assisting in the processing of these emotions (Peelen & Jansen, 2007). Hogenová (2002) asserts that pain brings us back to ourselves, that it is a route to being through the low points of our own vital force.

The data acquired from our pilgrims suggests that they were sufficiently prepared in advance for the physical and mental challenges of the pilgrimage, and in general, accepted pain positively. On the basis of the Christian tradition, it could be assumed that the Christians would cope with pain better, as they see it as a way to redemption, that is, as something positive, and yet our data does not imply this. In retrospect, both the religious and atheist pilgrims regarded pain as a positive phenomenon, sometimes much too abundant, but generally, pain was perceived as an important part of the experience, without which the pilgrimage would lack such a profound purpose, and thanks to which the pilgrimage became an exceptional experience, and not a mere hiking trip. This way, pain becomes one of the feelings of exclusivity compared to ordinary hikers (Tisdell, 2013). Pain also manifested itself by maintaining the pilgrims in the present moment; they remained 'on the road'.

Disengagement from everydayness

The phenomenon of Disengagement from Everydayness is closely related to free time. The perception of free time has an irreplaceable role in the process of self-knowledge. Aristotle (2016), in his treatise *Politics*, emphasises primarily the sense of free time, thanks to which everything is unveiled. In ancient Greece, free time was seen as a space for the cultivation of the self. Nowadays, free time is perceived as a space for the recovery of power for work and its purpose as increasing man's productivity (Heidegger, 1977). But the original purpose of free time was different. The essence of free time should not be measured by its purposefulness, as the purpose arises from its very nature (Pieper, 2009). It is a state where we are not limited by the necessity of something, but rather enjoy the simple essence of being; a state of mind in which the meaning of an activity slowly resurfaces by its very nature, as time is not a limit and does not push us forward. As one of the pilgrims stated: 'There's a wealth of time for everything' (J, I2). We arrive at a state in which we peacefully recapitulate our lives so far and find new directions and 'new insights, or the ability to see things from a different perspective.' Frey describes pilgrimage as 'leisure with meaning' (1998, p. 254). (K, I1) In his book *On the Theory of Action* (1994), Pierre Bourdieu speculates that people are only able to plan ahead if they control the present at least a little. We are capable of this if we stop for a while and think about what is happening around us. '… you can't actually experience that in civilisation' (R, I1). A pilgrimage is such a place because we are taken out of the system of everydayness and enter the timelessness of the pilgrimage. We enter the mode of living in the present moment. In this state, we often turn to ourselves and feel the need to recapitulate our lives so far. This is quite rare in the modern lifestyle, as it is characterised by the pursuit of profit in the competing market and free time is downplayed. In contrast to Aristotle (2016), who says that 'the goal of (work) is leisure', the current motto is, 'one does not work to live, one lives to work' (Pieper, 2009). Pieper writes about the obsession with productivity and sees the world of work as inauthentic. Thus, we do not have space to contemplate our lifestyle. Daniel Bell (1976) described a pilgrimage as opposing the capitalist, accelerated society. A pilgrimage is an escape from telephones and full diaries; this liberation brings the possibility of alternative experience of place, time, and the self; it is a new mode of 'being in the world' (Fullagar, Markwell, & Wilson, 2012). A walking pilgrimage is a specific kind of activity, thanks to which it is possible to leave one's routine. People come alone to a new environment where they are not pushed anywhere. Free time is spontaneously utilised for a deeper and fuller perception of simple existence: 'Everything takes place in the present' (H, D), 'there is time for everything' (Frey, 1998, p. 73). Time as such is perceived differently, and is

in accordance with the rhythm of our bodies (Parkins, 2004). Kolman and Štourač (1999) describe this as follows: 'Ideas about what will come tomorrow and the day after wane, they are not needed. It becomes easier to live in the present,' (p. 77), Čížková (2005) calls this 'one big Now' (p. 32). According to Carl Honoré (2005), a pilgrimage is a cultural revolution against the modern belief that 'faster means better' (p. 44). Modern man is characterised by a neurotic obsession with time. We get rid of this necessity on a pilgrimage; 'days become insignificant there' (H, D), and time changes from the ancient Chronos to Kairos, described by Heidegger (1977) as a state of being where everything around us starts to unfold in a unique way. In contrast, Chronos, represented by clock hands, defines precisely when we should do something. Chronos leads us away from authentic being, and therefore Heidegger adores Kairos as the path to authentic existence. Eliade (2009) calls this condition 'sacred time'; it is timelessness or a perpetually repeated present (illo tempore), where the difference between space, time, and existence has disintegrated. We cannot reach these states in our everyday lives. A pilgrimage is an escape from 'everydayness', and escape from routine, a way to live a full life; not just accept the day-to-day order, but open to something new. It is a journey during which the pilgrims 'contemplate their souls' (A, I1) and find 'truth in themselves' (K, I1). As Thomas Merton (1967, p. 92) suggests: 'The geographical pilgrimage is the symbolic acting out of an inner journey. The inner journey is the interpolation of the meanings and signs of the outer pilgrimage. One can have one without the other. It is best to have both.'

Disclosure statement

No potential conflict of interest was reported by the author(s).

Ethics approval

The research was approved under the number: 76/2021 by the Ethics Committee of the Faculty of Physical Culture Palacky University in Olomouc. Informed consent was obtained from all individual participants included in the study.

Notes on contributors

Jiri Malis MA belongs to Czech Republic. He is currently Assistant Professor, Palacky University Olomouc, Faculty of Physical Culture, Department of Social Sciences in Kinanthropology. His research interests include the phenomenon of the pilgrim experience and philosophical ethical issues in sport. His recent publication is Mališ, J. & Michalica, T. (2023). Why Carlos Ramos Was in Compliance with His Duty and USTA and WTA are Wrong in the Case of US Open 2018 Women's Final; Sport, *Sports, Ethics & Philosophy,* https://doi.org 10.1080/17511321.2023.2193759

David Masilka MA Ph.D. belongs to Czech Republic. Currently he is Assistant Professor in the Department of Recreation and Leisure Studies, Faculty of Physical Culture, Palacky University Olomouc. His research interests include experimental pedagogy (theoretical foundations; application in practice), qualitative research (methodology – creating research designs; moderating individual in-depth interviews including projective research techniques; moderating focus groups), and facilitation and coaching (workshops; individual meetings). His recent publication is Sigmund E., Másilka D., Sigmundová D., Frömel K., Novák M. (2005). The effect of interventional physical activity of residential camps in nature on the habitual physical activity of females and males. *Acta Univ. Palacki. Olomuc., Gymn*., 35(1), 43–51.

Kristyna Janeckova MA belongs to Czech Republic. She is currently pursuing a Ph.D., in the Department of Recreation and Leisure Studies, Faculty of Physical Culture, Palacky University Olomouc. Her research interests include the phenomenon of the search for meaning in elite athletes after the end of their sporting career. Her recent publication is Janeckova, K., Hamrik, Z., Matusova, M., & Badura, P. (2021). "I am going out!"–lifestyle sports and physical activity in adolescents. *BMC Public Health, 21*(1), 1–10.

ORCID

Jiri Malis http://orcid.org/0000-0003-4326-0518
Kristyna Janeckova http://orcid.org/0000-0002-7990-6803

References

Ahlbäck, T. (1993). *The problem of ritual*. Almlqvist & Wiksell International.

Allcock, J. B. (1988). Tourism as a sacred journey. *Society and Leisure*, *11*(1), 3–48. https://doi.org/10.1080/07053436.1988.10715288

Amaro, S., Antunes, A., & Henriques, C. (2018). A closer look at Santiago de Compostela's pilgrims through the lens of motivations. *Tourism Management*, *64*, 271–280. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tourman.2017.09.007

Aristotle. (2016). *Politics*. Leopold Classic Library.

Barreiro, J. (1997). *La Funcion Polftica de los Caminos de Peregrinacion en Ia Europa Medieval*. Tecnos.

Belk, W., & Costa, J. A. (1998). The mountain man myth: A contemporary consuming fantasy. *Journal of Consumer Research*, *25*(3), 218–240. https://doi.org/10.1086/209536

Bell, D. (1976). The cultural contradictions of capitalism. *Journal of Aesthetic Education*, *6*(1/2), 11–38. https://doi.org/10.2307/3331409

Berger, P. L., Berger, B., & Kellner, H. (1973). *The homeless mind: Modernization and consciousness*. Penguin.

Bottineau, Y. (1997). *Der Weg Der Jakobspilger Geschichte, Kunst Und Kultur Der Wallfahrt Nach Santiago de Compostela. 3*. Aufl. Bastei-Lübbe-Taschenbuch. Lübbe.

Brown, L. (2013). Tourism: A catalyst for existential authenticity. *Annals of Tourism Research*, *40*, 176–190. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.annals.2012.08.004

Bruner, E. (2005). *Culture on tour: Ethnographies of travel*. The University of Chicago Press.

Čížková, M. (2005). *Z Lurd do Santiaga: Cesta na konec světa*. Fontána.

Cohen, E., & Cohen, S. A. (2014). A mobilities approach to tourism from emerging world regions. *Current Issues in Tourism*, *18*(1), 11–43. https://doi.org/10.1080/13683500.2014.898617

Cole, B. S., & Pargament, K. I. (1999). Spiritual surrender: A paradoxical path to control. In W. R. Miller (Ed.), *Integrating spirituality into treatment: Resources for practitioners* (pp. 179–198). American Psychological Association. https://doi.org/10.1037/10327-009.

Collins-Kreiner, N., & Kliot, N. (2000). Pilgrimage tourism in the Holy Land: The behavioural characteristics of Christian pilgrims. *GeoJournal*, *1*(50), 55–67. https://doi.org/10.1023/A:1007154929681

Coplan, R. J., & Bowker, J. C. (2014). *The handbook of solitude: Psychological perspectives on social isolation, social withdrawal, and being alone*. Wiley.

Corbin, J., & Strauss, A. (2012). *Basics of qualitative research. Techniques and procedures for developing grounded theory*. Sage. https://doi.org/10.4135/9781452230153.

Csikszentmihalyi, M. (1990). *Flow: The psychology of optimal experience*. Harper & Row.

Davidson, L. K. (2014). *Reformulations of the pilgrimages to Santiago de Compostela*. Routledge.

Davie, G. (1994). *Religion in Britain since 1945 : Believing without belonging*. Blackwell.

Deneen, J. (2018). *Why liberalism failed*. Yale University Press.

Eliade, M. (2009). *The myth of the eternal return, or, cosmos and history*. Arkana.

Farias, M., Coleman, T. J., Bartlett, J. E., Oviedo, L., Soares, P., Santos, T., … Bas, M. d. C. (2018). Atheists on the Santiago Way: Examining motivations to go on pilgrimage. *Sociology of Religion*, *80*(1), 28–44. https://doi.org/10.1093/socrel/sry019

Figurski, L. (2012). *The courage to think for yourself : The search for truth and the meaning of human life*. University Press of America.

Frankl, V. (2006). *Man's search for meaning*. Beacon Press.

Frey, L. (1998). *Pilgrim stories, on and off the road to Santiago*. UC Press.

Fullagar, M., Markwell, K., & Wilson, E. (2012). *Slow tourism: Experiences and mobilities*. Channel View Publications.

Gamper, M., & Reuter, J. (2012). Pilgern als spirituelle Selbstfindung oder religiöse Pflicht? Empirische Befunde zur Pilgerpraxis auf dem Jakobsweg. In Daniel Schäfer, F. Hillebrandt, & H. Wienold (Eds.), *Doing modernity - doing religion* (pp. 205–232). Springer VS. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-531-94329-9_8.

Glucklich, A. (2003). *Sacred pain: Hurting the body for the sake of the soul*. Oxford University Press.

Goffman, E. (1959). *The presentation of self in everyday life. Contemporary sociological theory*. Anchor Books.

Gökarıksel, B. (2009). Beyond the officially sacred: Religion, secularism, and the body in the production of subjectivity. *Social & Cultural Geography*, *10*(6), 657–674. https://doi.org/10.1080/14649360903068993

González, R., & Medina, J. (2003). Cultural tourism and urban management in northwestern Spain: The pilgrimage to Santiago de Compostela. *Tourism Geographies*, *5*(4), 446–460. https://doi.org/10.1080/1461668032000129164

Good, J. (1994). *Medicine, rationality, and experience. Animal genetics*. Harvard University.

Grün, A. (2005). *Auf dem Wege: zu einer Theologie des Wanderns*. VierTürme-Verlag.

Guilarte, P. Y., & González, L. R. (2018). Sustainability and visitor management in tourist historic cities: The case of Santiago de Compostela, Spain. *Journal of Heritage Tourism*, *13*(6), 489–505. https://doi.org/10.1080/1743873X.2018.1435665

Hammitt, E. (1982). Cognitive dimensions of wilderness solitude. *Environment and Behavior*, *14*(4), 478–493. https://doi.org/10.1177/0013916582144005

Heidegger, M. (1977). *The question concerning technology and other essays X*. Harper & Row, Publishers, Inc.

Herrmann, L., Böckler, A., Trautwein, F. M., Holmes, T., & Singer, T. (2017). Know thy selves: Learning to understand oneself increases the ability to understand others. *Journal of Cognitive Enhancement*, *1*(2), 197–207. https://doi.org/10.1007/s41465-017-0023-6

Hogenová, A. (2002). *Kvalita Života a Tělesnost*. Karolinum.

Honoré, C. (2005). *In praise of slowness : Challenging the cult of speed*. Deckle Edge.

Jackson, E. (2016). Alone and together with myself: How do we experience solitude? *Existential Analysis: Journal of the Society for Existential Analysis*, *27*(2), 406–418.

Jirásek, I. (2014). Fenomén putování jako symbol duchovního rozměru osobnostního rozvoje v diskursu zážitkové pedagogiky. *Pedagogická Orientace*, *24*(1), 5–21. https://doi.org/10.5817/PedOr2014-1-5

Kapusta, J. (2011). Odkaz Victora Turnera v Současné Antropologii Poutnictví: Zkušenost Pouti Do Santiaga de Compostela. *Český Lid*, *98*(2), 135–153. https://www.jstor.org/stable/42640395.

Kim, H., & Jamal, T. (2007). Touristic quest for existential authenticity. *Annals of Tourism Research*, *34*(1), 181–201. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.annals.2006.07.009

Kolman, I., & Štourač, J. (1999). *Cesta do Compostely: Pěšky napříč Evropou*. Karmelitánské nakladatelství.

Koopmans, R. (2011). *Wonderful to relate: Miracle stories and miracle collecting in high medieval England*. University of Pennsylvania Press.

Korstanje, M. (2018). *Risk and safety challenges for religious tourism and events*. University of Palermo.

Larson, W. (1990). The solitary side of life: An examination of the time people spend alone from childhood to old age. *Developmental Review*, *10*(2), 155–183. https://doi.org/10.1016/0273-2297(90)90008-R

Lawrence, C. H. (2001). *Medieval monasticism : Forms of religious life in Western Europe in the middle ages*. Longman.

Lewis, C. S. (2012). *The Screwtape letters: Letters from a senior to a junior devil*. Collins.

Long, C. R., & Averill, J. R. (2003). Solitude: An exploration of benefits of being alone. *Journal for the Theory of Social Behaviour*, *33*(1), 21–44. https://doi.org/10.1111/1468-5914.00204

Lopez, L. (2013). How long does the pilgrimage tourism experience to Santiago de Compostela last? *International Journal of Religious Tourism and Pilgrimage*, *1*(1), 1–14. https://doi.org/10.21427/D7C133

MacCannell, D. (1976). *The tourist: A new theory of the leisure class*. Schocken Books.

Merton, T. (1967). *Mystics and Zen Masters*. New York: Farrar, Straus and Giroux.

Miles, K., Louise, K., & Macrae, C. (2009). The rhythm of rapport: Interpersonal synchrony and social perception. *Journal of Experimental Social Psychology*, *45*(3), 585–589. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jesp.2009.02.002

Müller, B. (2003). *Španělskem Od Jihu k Severu. Quo Vadis, Poutníku?. Via Lucis*. Vlastní náklad.

Nietzsche, F., & Middleton, C. (1969). *Selected letters of Friedrich Nietzsche*. University of Chicago Press.

Nilsson, M. (2018). Wanderers in the shadow of the sacred myth: Pilgrims in the 21st century. *Social & Cultural Geography*, *19*(1), 21–38. https://doi.org/10.1080/14649365.2016.1249398

Nilsson, M., & Tesfahuney, M. (2016). Performing the 'post-secular' in Santiago de Compostela. *Annals of Tourism Research*, *57*(3), 18–30. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.annals.2015.11.001

Ohler, N. (2003). *Cestování ve středověku*. H+H.

Oviedo, L., De Courcier, S., & Farias, M. (2014). Rise of pilgrims on the Camino to Santiago: Sign of change or religious revival? *Review of Religous Research*, *56*(3), 433–442. https://doi.org/10.1007/s13644-013-0131-4

Parkins, W. (2004). Out of time: Fast subjects and slow living. *Time and Society*, *13*(23), 363–382. https://doi.org/10.1177/0961463X04045662

Patočka, J. (1969). *Úvod Do Husserlovy Fenomenologie*. Státní pedagogické nakladatelství.

Pedersen, M. (1999). Model for types of privacy by privacy functions. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, *19*(4), 397–405. https://doi.org/10.1006/jevp.1999.0140

Peelen, J., & Jansen, W. (2007). Emotive movement on the road to Santiago de Compostela. *Etnofoor*, *20*(1), 75–96. http://www.jstor.org/stable/25758131.

Pieper, J. (2009). *Leisure: The basis of culture*. Ignatius Press.

Preston, J., & Morinis, A. (1992). Spiritual magnetism: An organizing principle for the study of pilgrimage. *Sacred Journeys: The Anthropology of Pilgrimage*, *15*(2), 31–46. https://www.sharedsacredsites.net/repository-items/zr7hr0jwqeegmirl7×61rsp3we3joh.

Reader, I. (2007). Pilgrimage growth in the modern world: Meanings and implications. *Religion*, *37*(3), 210–229. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.religion.2007.06.009

Rothbaum, R., Weisz, J., & Snyder, S. (1982). Changing the world and changing the self: A two process model of perceived control. *Journal for the Scientific Study of Religion and Health*, *33*(1), 5–37. https://doi.org/10.1037/0022-3514.42.1.5

Sánchez-Carretero, C. (2015). Heritagization of the Camino to Finisterre. *GeoJournal Library*, *117*, 95–119. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-20212-9_4

Santos, M. (2016). The way of Saint James as an event: Politics and nation. *Journal of Policy Research in Tourism, Leisure and Events*, *8*(3), 233–248. https://doi.org/10.1080/19407963.2016.1214960

Santos, M. (2022). The Way of St. James in religious tourism research. *International Journal of Religious Tourism and Pilgrimage*, *9*(6), 11. https://doi.org/10.21427/jx2k-hk69

Schnell, T., & Pali, S. (2013). Pilgrimage today: The meaning-making potential of ritual. *Mental Health, Religion & Culture*, *16*(9), 887–902. https://doi.org/10.1080/13674676.2013.766449

Seligman, B. (2008). *Ritual and Its consequences : An essay on the limits of sincerity*. Oxford University Press.

Sharpley, R., & Jepson, D. (2011). Rural tourism: A spiritual experience? *Annals of Tourism Research*, *38*(1), 52–71. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.annals.2010.05.002

Sharpley, R., & Sundaram, P. (2005). Tourism: A sacred journey? The case of ashram tourism, India. *The International Journal of Tourism Research*, *7*(3), 161–171. https://doi.org/10.1002/jtr.522

Sheldrake, R. (1994). The rebirth of nature. *RSA Journal*, *142*(5447), 46–58. https://www.jstor.org/stable/41376392

Sørensen, A., & Høgh-Olesen, H. (2022). Walking for well-being. Exploring the phenomenology of modern pilgrimage. *Culture & Psychology*, *29*(1). https://doi.org/10.1177/1354067X22113135

Sosis, R., & Alcorta, C. (2003). Signaling, solidarity, and the sacred: The evolution of religious behavior. *Evolutionary Anthropology: Issues, News, and Reviews*, *12*(6), 264–274. https://doi.org/10.1002/evan.10120

Statista. (2022). *Number of pilgrims who traveled to Santiago de Compostela, Spain from 2010 to 2021*. https://www.statista.com/statistics/772722/annual-number-of-pilgrims-who-walked-the-way-of-st-james-to-santiago-de-compostela-spain/

Storr, A. (1989). *Solitude : A return to the self*. Ballantine Books.

Szerb, A. B., Bakucz, M., & Martínez-Cortijo, F. J. (2016). The impact of the Santiago Pilgrimage Way on rural Spain. The case of the French Way (Northern Spain). *Journal of Tourism Challenges and Trends*, *9*(1), 47–63.

Tignor, S. M., & Colvin, C. R. (2019). The meaning of guilt: Reconciling the past to inform the future. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, *116*(6), 989. https://doi.org/10.1037/pspp0000216

Tilson, J. (2005). Religious-Spiritual tourism and promotional campaigning: A church-state partnership for St. James and Spain. *Journal of Hospitality & Leisure Marketing*, *12*(1-2), 9–40. https://doi.org/10.1300/J150v12n01_03

Tisdell, J. (2013). *We make the Way by walking: Spiritual pilgrimage and transformative learning while walking the Camino De Santiago*. New Prairie Press. https://newprairiepress.org/aerc

Turner, C., & Manning, P. (2016). Placing authenticity—On being a tourist: A reply to Pearce and Moscardo. *Journal of Sociology*, *24*(1), 136–139. https://doi.org/10.1177/144078338802400108

Turner, E., & Turner, V. (1978). *Image and pilgrimage in Christian culture: Anthropological perspectives*. Columbia University Press.

Turner, V., & Turner, E. (1996). *Image and pilgrimage in Christian culture : Anthropological perspectives*. Columbia University Press.

Wang, N. (1999). Rethinking authenticity in tourism experience. *Annals of Tourism Research*, *26*(2), 349–370. https://doi.org/10.1016/S0160-7383(98)00103-0

Wilson, B. (2021). I. Secularization: The inherited model. In P. Hammond (Ed.), *The sacred in a secular age* (pp. 9–20). University of California Press. https://doi.org/10.1525/9780520325425-002/HTML